

India will now incubate electronics start-ups

In a bid to boost the electronics ecosystem in the country, the Indian government has come up with the idea of setting up four hubs to incubate electronics start-ups. These hubs will be created across the country and will help start-ups that specialise in electronics. Recently, the government had also approved the establishment of two semiconductor fabrication units.

The Indian government is working at growing the electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM) sector in the country by facilitating local manufacturing and putting a restraint on the import of electronics goods. Taking a step in this direction, it had earlier announced the Electronics Policy 2012 along with a two billion dollar electronics development fund.

Home-grown solar products to boost Indian solar power industry

As per report titled 'Indian Solar Power Industry: Outlook to 2017,' the cumulative solar PV-installed capacity in India is projected to grow at a CAGR of 31.5 per cent during



Solar panels

AIREA West elects new managing committee members

The All India Radio & Electronic Association (AIREA) West has elected its new managing committee members. While Javerchand Gala, director of Vegakit (India) Pvt Ltd, will be the new president, Nayan Parekh takes over as vice president and Mitesh Mody has been elected the new secretary for the period 2013-15. The association, which celebrated its platinum jubilee last year, represents all sections of the electronics trade and industry.

HCL Infosystems announces the appointment of two new directors

HCL Infosystems has announced the appointment of two new independent non-executive directors, Sangeeta Talwar and Kaushik Dutta on its board.

2012-16. The growing need for energy, and shortages in conventional power generation sources, has triggered the demand for solar photovoltaic panels and other such products. As a result, manufacturers are expanding their existing capacities to meet the rising demand in the country.

The manufacturers have also garnered support from the government, which has initiated subsidy schemes for them. This would help domestic panel producers to scale up operations and improve their cost-competitiveness.

Karnataka gets approval for electronics cluster

The electronics industry in the state of Karnataka has got a big boost with the

in-principle approval of a ₹ 850 million electronics cluster. The cluster has been approved by the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY).

The state will now

set up its first ESDM brownfield cluster development project in the Electronic City near Bengaluru, informed S.R. Patil, state minister for IT, Biotechnology and Science and Technology. The brownfield cluster aims to accelerate the growth of the ESDM industry in Karnataka, and will be set up at an estimated cost of ₹ 851.5 million.

Interim budget presented by the finance minister

Contrary to expectations, the finance minister has made changes in the Interim Budget in the excise duty applicable to some commodities.

The excise duty on all goods falling under Chapters 84 and 85 of the Schedule to the Central Excise Duty has been reduced to 10 per cent from 12 per cent for a period up to June end this year. This is designed to stimulate growth in capital goods and consumer non-durables.

Even though finance minister, P. Chidambaram, made an attempt to spur local manufacturing of 'Made in India' cell phones by cutting excise duty, low-end models will cost a tad more as there is no supporting manufacturing ecosystem in the country. To encourage domestic production of mobile handsets (which has declined) and reduce the dependence on imports (which have